

## Amino acids

PEPTIDE  
PEPTJDE  
PE(?PTI)DE

Amino acids are written as the standard IUPAC symbols. With O/U added as pyrrolysine, and selenocysteine. J/B/Z are ambiguous amino acids for I/L, N/D, and Q/E respectively. Lastly X is added as any unknown amino acid. X is defined to have a mass of zero. So 'X[+435]' can be used to indicate a mass gap of 435 Da.

## Modifications

Modifications are defined between square brackets '[mod]'. Multiple definitions can be combined with a vertical line '|' like so '[mod|mod|mod]'.

Monoisotopic mass PEPTI[+15.995]DE  
Molecular formula PEPTI[Formula:0]DE  
Name (Unimod/PSI-MOD) PEPTI[Oxidation]DE  
Name specific ontology PEPTI[U:Oxidation]DE  
Index specific ontology PEPTI[UNIMOD:35]DE  
Comment or description PEPTI[INFO:text]DE  
Glycan composition PEPN[Glycan:HexNAc5Hex5dHex1NeuAc2]ITDE  
Glycan structure PEPN[GNO:G75079FY]ITDE  
Charged molecular formula PEPTI[Formula:H-2Zn1:z+2]DE

## Modification prefixes

| Mass | Name    | Index  | Description                    |
|------|---------|--------|--------------------------------|
| U    | U?      | Unimod | Modifications from Unimod      |
| M    | M?      | PSIMOD | Modifications from PSI MOD     |
| R    | R       | Resid  | Modifications from Resid       |
| X    | X       | XLMOD  | Modifications from XL-MOD      |
| G    | G       | GNO    | Modifications from GNOme       |
| Obs  | -       | -      | To indicate an observed mass   |
| -    | INFO    | -      | To add comments or description |
| -    | Glycan  | -      | Glycan compositions            |
| -    | Formula | -      | Molecular formulas             |



## Locations

### Localised

PEPT[mod][mod]IDE (Multiple) modifications on the side chain of an amino acid  
[mod][mod]-PEPTIDE (Multiple) modifications on the N terminus  
PEPTIDE-[mod][mod] (Multiple) modifications on the C terminus  
{mod}PEPTIDE Labile modification, on this peptidoform  
<mod@E,N-term>PEPTIDE Fixed modification

### Unlocalised

[mod]^n?PEPTIDE On the entire peptidoform  
PEPT[mod#name]ID[#name]E On the given locations  
PEP(TID)[mod]E Within the given stretch

The order of all options when used together

<mod@E>[mod]^n?{mod}[mod]-PEP-[mod]

Using unlocalised rules

PEP(TID[mod])[mod|Position:T,D|CoMKP]E

### Unlocalised additional rules

Position:E,N-term Limit the allowed positions, uses the same positions as fixed modifications  
Limit:2 Limit the maximal number on one site, only for ^n global unlocalised modifications  
CoMKP Allows colocalising with placed modifications  
CoMUP Allows colocalising with other unlocalised modifications

## Combining peptidoforms

PEPTIDE+PEPTIDE Chimeric peptidoforms (forming one compound peptidoform ion)  
PEPT[mod#XLname]IDE//PEPT[#XLname]IDE Cross-linked peptidoforms (forming one peptidoform ion)  
PEPT[mod#BRANCH]IDE//PEP[#BRANCH]TIDE Branched peptidoforms (forming one peptidoform ion)  
PEPT[mod#XLname]IDE[#XLname] Intra linked cross-linked peptidoform

## Charge

PEPTIDE/2 Global charge, assumed to be protons  
PEPTIDE/[Na:z+1,H:z+1] Defined charge carriers, in this case 1 unlocalised sodium and 1 unlocalised proton  
PEP[Formula:Na:z+1]TIDE/1 Defined charge carriers, in this case 1 localised sodium and 1 unlocalised proton, this still has a global charge of 2

## Name

To add a description or metadata to an entire (compound) peptidoform (ion). To do this for single locations or stretches use the INFO tag.

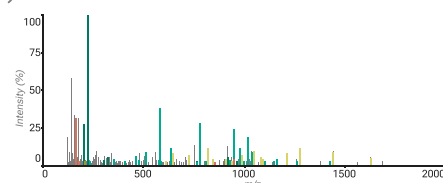
(>Peptidoform name)PEPTIDE  
(>>Peptidoform ion name)PEPT[mod#XLname]IDE//PEPT[#XLname]IDE  
(>>>Compound peptidoform ion name)PEPTIDE+PEPTIDE

## Universal Spectrum Identifier

mzspec:<ID>:<file>:scan:<number>:<peptidoform>  
index:<number>  
nativeId:<number>(,<number>)\*

mzspec:PXD023419:Peng2021\_Herceptin\_aLP.raw:scan:11368:RWGGDGFYAM[Oxidation]DYWGQGTLVTV/3

USIs are the URL for the mass spectrometry world. A USI points to a Proteomics Exchange Identifier (PXD...), a file, and a spectrum in that file. Additionally, a peptidoform can be added to the end, note that many servers require the peptidoform and a global charge state for the peptidoform.



ProForma v2.1  
psidev.info/proforma  
USI  
psidev.info/usi

Author :  
Douwe Schulte  
April 2025  
CC BY-NC 4.0  
V1.0

